LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why Time Goes Faster as We Get Older

Why our years seem to disappear, what really makes time feel longer, lots of useful time expressions – and Lucy's mum's "firsts jar".



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 💬
Solve the crossword, start your own firsts jar and share a "first" in the comments!

0 Warm-up: My firsts this year

fun · no points

Tick everything you did **for the first time** this year. Then count your ticks!

- ☐ 🍣 tried a new food
- ☐ 🗺️ visited a new place
- ☐ 🎨 learned a new skill
- ☐ 🤝 made a new friend
- ☐ 🎬 watched a film in English
- ☐ 🚶 took a new way home

My firsts this year: _____

Guess! In a study of 499 people, did older people feel that the last **week** passed faster than young people did?

(a) yes, much faster (b) no – about the same

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 2:19**

Jack: "Where did this year go? It feels like it was January about five minutes ago!" 🗓️



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. Does time feel faster now than when you were a child?

2. What's your most vivid memory from childhood?

3. What did you do last Tuesday? Can you remember? 😅

4. What's something you did for the first time this year?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Check in the Word Tour at ⏱️ 14:10

- ☐ **1.** to fly by
- ☐ **2.** to drag
- ☐ **3.** a routine
- ☐ **4.** novelty
- ☐ **5.** to look back
- ☐ **6.** vivid
- ☐ **7.** a paradox
- ☐ **8.** to reminisce
- ☐ **9.** to lose track of time
- ☐ **10.** a blur

a) to seem to pass very slowly, usually because you're bored
b) very clear, bright or detailed
c) the quality of being new or unusual
d) to think about something in the past
e) something that seems impossible, because two opposite things are both true
f) your usual way of doing things, in the usual order
g) to pass very quickly
h) to remember and talk about the past, usually with pleasure
i) a time you can't remember clearly because it went so fast
j) to not notice how much time has passed



Pronunciation corner 🔊 **NOV**-el-ty · **VIV**-id · **PAR**-a-dox · rou-**TINE** · rem-i-**NISCE**. And the irregular verb: fly → **flew** → **flown**. Say it out loud: *"Looking back, that year flew by!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Time really moves faster for older people, and nothing can change it.
- (b) Years feel short when they leave few new memories – so small new experiences make time feel fuller.
- (c) The best way to slow down time is to have the same routine every day.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

supermarket · dentist · mountains · pasta · bakery · piano · crossword · pottery

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. If time "drags", it feels…

(a) very fast
(b) very slow
(c) very exciting

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

2. "I moved here two years _____."

(a) before
(b) since
(c) ago

🧠 Grammar you know

3. "Tell me about it!" usually means…

(a) I completely agree
(b) please tell me more
(c) I don't believe you

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

4. A "routine" is…

(a) a long holiday
(b) something you do for the first time
(c) your usual way of doing things

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

5. A "vivid" memory is…

(a) very clear and detailed
(b) very old
(c) very boring

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. How many people took part in the Munich study?

(a) 99
(b) 499
(c) 4,900

🎧 ⏱️ 2:19

7. For the last hour or week, younger and older people…

(a) felt very different speeds
(b) felt about the same speed
(c) couldn't answer

🎧 ⏱️ 2:19

8. When we look back, our brain measures time by counting…

(a) birthdays
(b) days on the calendar
(c) memories

🎧 ⏱️ 4:10

9. On his new way to work, Jack saw a dog wearing…

(a) a little scarf
(b) sunglasses
(c) a hat

🎧 ⏱️ 8:29

10. After the first year, how many papers were in the jar?

(a) 28
(b) 51
(c) 43

🎧 ⏱️ 19:17

🧩 **Fun fact:** The people in the Munich study were aged from **14 to 94** – that's 80 years between the youngest and the oldest!

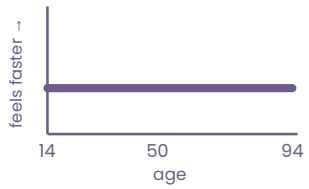
4 Read the research 📊

new! graphs · 4 points

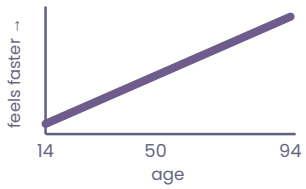


In the Munich study, people of different ages said how fast time felt. Listen at ⏱️ 2:19, then choose the right graph (2 points each).

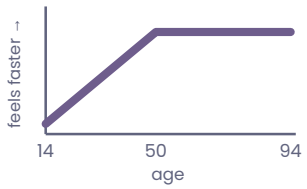
a



b



c



1. Which graph shows how fast **the last week** felt? ☐

2. Which graph shows how fast **the last ten years** felt? ☐

Bonus (no points): the "maths theory" says a year is a smaller part of your life when you're older. Which graph does it predict for **the last week**? ⏱️ 7:09 ☐

5 True or false?

listening · 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Last week, Lucy saw Christmas decorations in a supermarket.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	In the Munich study, the last ten years felt faster and faster after the age of 50.	T	F	⏱️ 2:19
3	In the study from Israel, routine made time feel **longer** in memory.	T	F	⏱️ 4:48
4	We remember a lot from about the ages of 15 to 25.	T	F	⏱️ 6:08
5	Claudia Hammond thinks the "maths theory" explains time very well.	T	F	⏱️ 7:09
6	Lucy says learning English is "a machine for making new memories".	T	F	⏱️ 8:29



6 Two clocks in your head

think · 4 points

Is the person measuring time **while it's happening**, or **looking back**? Tick one. ⏱️ 3:35

1. "This meeting is taking forever!" 😩

☐ ⏱️ WHILE IT'S HAPPENING ☐ 🔙 LOOKING BACK

2. "How long ago was that holiday?" 🤔

☐ ⏱️ WHILE IT'S HAPPENING ☐ 🔙 LOOKING BACK

3. "When I think about the mountains now, it feels like a month." 🏔️

☐ ⏱️ WHILE IT'S HAPPENING ☐ 🔙 LOOKING BACK

4. "This holiday is flying by – it's Friday already!" 🏖️

☐ ⏱️ WHILE IT'S HAPPENING ☐ 🔙 LOOKING BACK

🏖️ **The holiday paradox:** a great holiday flies by while you're there – but when you look back, it feels long, because it's full of new memories.

7 "How long has it been?" listening 10 points



Two old friends meet for coffee after a long time. Listen at ⏱ 11:50 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱ 12:56 can help.



LUCY
Jack! Finally! I was starting to think you'd forgotten.

JACK
Sorry, sorry! I lost 1 _____ of time. Wow, it's so good to see you. How long has it been?





LUCY
Almost a year, can you believe it? The last time we met was at the end of last summer.

JACK
No way. It feels like only 2 _____. This year has 3 _____ by.





LUCY
Tell me about it. I 4 _____, and suddenly it's October.

JACK
So what have you been 5 _____ to?





LUCY
Well, actually, I've been doing something new every month. Last month I took a pottery class. It was a disaster, but I had the time of my 6 _____.

JACK
That sounds amazing. My year's been a bit of a 7 _____. Work, home, work, home.





LUCY
Then let's change that. Are you free next Saturday? There's a market in a town I've never visited.

JACK
You know what? I'll make time for it. Count me 8 _____.





LUCY
Perfect. I'll send you the details tonight.

A. Which phrase means **"I completely agree"**? Careful – it's a trick!

_____

B. Which phrase means **"Yes, I'll join you"**?

_____

🎭 **Say it out loud!** Play both parts – and talk about something **you** did for the first time this month.

8 Fast or slow?

time expressions · 8 points

Does each sentence describe time going **fast** ⚡ or time feeling **slow / long** 🐢? Write the letters (a–h) in the right box. ⏱️ 14:10



a The weekend flew by.
b I waited ages for the bus.
c This queue is taking forever.
d Time flies!
e We'll be there in no time.
f The last hour of work dragged.
g I haven't seen you for ages!
h My year's been a bit of a blur.

⚡ FAST
time passes quickly

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

🐢 SLOW / LONG
time passes slowly, or a long time

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐



Did you know? "Ages" is informal English for **a very long time**: *"I haven't seen you for ages!"* And **"in no time"** means **very quickly**: *"We'll be there in no time."*

9 What do we do with time?

new! collocations · 6 points

Complete each sentence with a verb from the box. Change the form if you need to.

have · **kill** · **lose** · **make** · **spend** · **waste**

1. I always _____ track of time when I'm reading a good book.
2. Yesterday I _____ time at the airport by doing a crossword.
3. I'm very busy this week, but I'll _____ time for your party.
4. Last Sunday we _____ the whole afternoon walking in the park.
5. Don't _____ time worrying about small things!
6. The pottery class was a disaster, but Lucy _____ the time of her life.



Jack's tip: We **have** a good time – we don't "spend" a good time. But we **spend** time doing something: *"I spent the evening reading."*

10 for · since · ago

new! grammar · 6 points

Three little words, three different jobs. ⏱️ 17:02



for + a period
how long?
"for an hour", "for ages", "for two years"

since + a starting point
from when?
"since Monday", "since 2019", "since I was a child"

period + ago
how far back in the past?
*"two years ago" – **ago** comes **after** the time!*

1. I moved to London two years _____.
2. I've been waiting for you _____ an hour!
3. Lucy's mum has kept a firsts jar every year _____ she turned sixty.
4. We haven't seen each other _____ ages!
5. Jack started walking a new way to work a month _____.
6. I've known my best friend _____ 2015.

💡 With **for** and **since**, we often use the present perfect: *"I've lived here for two years."* With **ago**, we use the past simple: *"I moved here two years ago."*

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 17:02

😐 1. "The time is passing very fast." 😊 _____

😐 2. "I spent a very good time at the party." 😊 _____

😐 3. "I have no time for to study." 😊 _____

😐 4. "Every day is same, it is boring." 😊 _____

😐 5. "What are you doing recently?" (to an old friend) 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: "the same" always needs **"the"**: *"Every day feels the same."* And we usually say **"Time flies!"** – not "the time flies".

🪞 **Now talk about you!** (no points) Finish the sentences with **for**, **since** or **ago** – then say them out loud.

I've lived in my home _____.

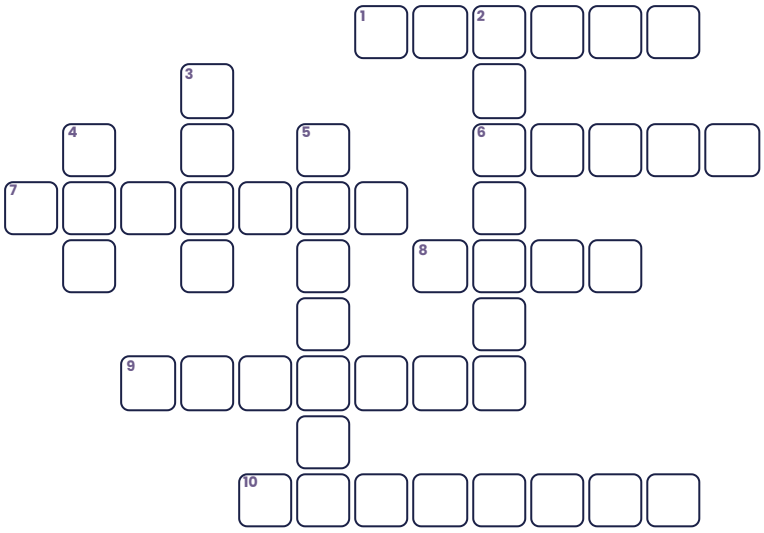
I started learning English _____.

I haven't been on holiday _____.

12 Time crossword 🧩 new! puzzle 10 points



Read the clues and write the words in the grid (1 point each). The number in brackets is the number of letters. Letters that cross help you!



➡️ Across

1 The 2005 study of 499 people was done in ___, in Germany. (6)

6 "I have a ___ memory of my first day at school." (5)

7 Two things that look opposite are both true: a ___. (7)

8 "My year's been a bit of a ___ – work, home, work, home." (4)

9 On a great ___, time flies – but looking back, it feels long. (7)

10 When we look back, our brain measures time by counting ___. (8)

⬇️ Down

2 ___ means newness. It's why a child's year feels so long. (7)

3 "The last hour of work always seems to ___." (4)

4 Lucy's mum keeps her "firsts" in a glass ___. (3)

5 The same journey, the same desk, the same lunch: your daily ___. (7)



13 Lucy's mum's firsts jar listening 6 points

Listen at ⏱️ 19:17. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 🍯 On New Year's Day, she put an empty glass jar on the kitchen shelf.
- ☐ 🎂 Lucy's mum turned sixty and said the years were going so fast.
- ☐ ✍️ Every time she did something for the first time, she wrote it down.
- ☐ 📖 The next New Year's Day, she read all the papers to the family.
- ☐ 🌟 This year, Lucy started her own jar.
- ☐ 💬 She said, "That was the longest year I've had in a very long time."

Think about it 💭 (no points) Why did that year feel so long – in the best way?



14 Your turn: your firsts

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence.

A. This week, for the first time, I... 🌟

Write two sentences in the **past simple**. *e.g. "This week, for the first time, I cooked a Thai curry."*

B. It's the first time I've... 🎉

Imagine you're doing something new **right now**. Use **It's the first time I've + past participle**. *e.g. "It's the first time I've swum in the sea in October!"*

🍯 Start your own firsts jar

your mission

Cut out the slips. Every time you do something for the first time, write it – in English! – and put it in a jar. Open it on New Year's Day. ✂️

🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____
🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____	🌟 First time I... Date: _____

💡 Ideas: a new street, a new food, a new café, a new word you actually used, your first film in English without subtitles...

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

⚡ FAST	🐢 SLOW	👋 CATCH UP	✅ AGREE
Time flies!	It's taking forever.	How long has it been?	Tell me about it!
The weekend flew by.	The last hour dragged.	What have you been up to?	Count me in!
We'll be there in no time.	I haven't seen you for ages!		

Can you do it now?

I can...	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain why years seem to go faster when we look back.	😟	🙂	😄
use time expressions like fly by, drag and in no time.	😟	🙂	😄
use for, since and ago correctly.	😟	🙂	😄
plan small new things to make my year fuller.	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Tell us in the comments – start with **"This week, for the first time, I..."** And if you start your own jar, tell us how many firsts you've got! 💜

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: b – for short periods there was almost no difference between ages. · Predict: **piano** 🎹 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 g · 2 a · 3 f · 4 c · 5 d · 6 b · 7 e · 8 h · 9 j · 10 i
Big idea: b (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 c · 3 a · 4 c · 5 a · 6 b · 7 b · 8 c · 9 a · 10 c

4 · Read the research (2 points each)

1 a (flat – about the same for all ages) · 2 c (faster and faster until about 50, then the same)
Bonus: b – but the real results don't match it!

5 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (after 50 it stayed about the same) · 3 F (shorter) · 4 T · 5 F (the memory explanation fits better) · 6 T

6 · Two clocks in your head

1 while it's happening · 2 looking back · 3 looking back · 4 while it's happening

7 · "How long has it been?"

1 track · 2 yesterday · 3 flown · 4 blinked · 5 up · 6 life · 7 blur · 8 in · A "Tell me about it." · B "Count me in."

8 · Fast or slow?

⚡ FAST: a, d, e, h · 🐢 SLOW / LONG: b, c, f, g

9 · What do we do with time?

1 lose · 2 killed · 3 make · 4 spent · 5 waste · 6 had

10 · for · since · ago

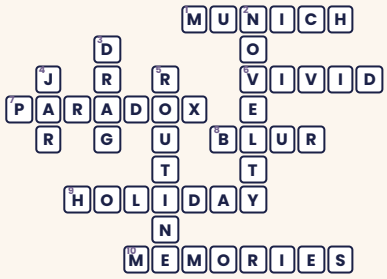
1 ago · 2 for · 3 since · 4 for · 5 ago · 6 since

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 Time flies! / Where has the time gone? · 2 I had a great time at the party. · 3 I don't have time to study. / I can't find the time to study. · 4 Every day feels the same. / I'm stuck in a bit of a routine. · 5 What have you been up to?

12 · Crossword

Across: 1 munich · 6 vivid · 7 paradox · 8 blur · 9 holiday · 10 memories
Down: 2 novelty · 3 drag · 4 jar · 5 routine



13 · The firsts jar · 14 · Your turn

1 🎂 turned sixty · 2 🍯 empty jar · 3 ✍️ wrote it down · 4 📖 read the papers · 5 💬 "the longest year" · 6 🌟 Lucy's own jar
Think about it: 43 firsts = lots of new memories, so the year felt full.
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **Time master!** · 70–89 ⚡ **Flying by** · 50–69 🗓️ **Making the most of it** · 0–49 🐢 **Take your time – listen again!**

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